FOUNDER DOCUMENTARY · M.S. PRODUCT INNOVATION · UNIVERSITY OF ARKANSAS

# BEAR WITH ME
# THE READY KIT

**Session record: from the first brief to the app leaving Claude.**

October 13–25, 2026 · Jessica Boyd, working with Claude

What we worked through, the prompts, the testing, each round of changes, and Jessica's decisions, with the conversation at the end. A second record covers October 30–31.

# AT A GLANCE

Over four working sessions, a creative brief became a brand, a working AI prototype, a usability test kit, a 20-page pocket booklet with a QR code, a printed proof, and a standalone Ask the Bear app that testers can use without a Claude account.

| When (Central) | What happened |
|---|---|
| Oct 13 · 9:40–11:50 AM | From Jessica's creative brief: design system, three bear logo concepts, concept screens (organizer, guidebook, phone), the photo + chat flow, and the first working **Ask the Bear** prototype. |
| Oct 21 · 10:40–11:20 PM | Design work saved to the project's GitHub (pull request #1). Printable usability test kit designed: facilitator guide, 8 scenario cards, answer key, score sheets (pull request #2). |
| Oct 24 · 1:20–2:00 AM | Jessica's booklet brief. Format and structure, page-by-page content with verify flags, two printed size tests. **3.5 × 5 in chosen.** First 16-page visual prototype. |
| Oct 24 · 2:00–2:50 AM | Illustrations reworked three times (v1 → v2 from her inspiration image → v3). Bear simplified at her request. All 16 pages rebuilt in v3. |
| Oct 24 · 3:10–3:35 AM | Three tab styles compared, A chosen; orange heading bar dropped. Missing lights added; booklet grows to **20 pages**. Readability pass. |
| Oct 25 · ~4:00–6:20 PM | Full 20-page build shown. QR code with a link that never changes (GitHub Pages forwarder). First home-printable proof. |
| Oct 25 · ~6:20–8:30 PM | Decided not to share her Claude login with testers. **Ask the Bear moved into its own code** with demo mode; 14 booklet lights and My car's numbers added. |
| Oct 25 · ~8:30–9:45 PM | Photo error found on her phone and traced. Claude version updated (booklet bear, Call buttons, photo permission, saving). Her judgment examples collected into the build record. |

**How this record was made.** Claude's word-for-word replies from these dates are no longer stored in this session, so this record is rebuilt from: Jessica's prompts (word for word from Oct 24, about 3 AM, onward; earlier ones are excerpts from the AI-use log and the build record, or described), the project's build record and founder-decisions notes, GitHub commit history, artifact save times, her attached briefs, and the screenshots taken during the work. Times are approximate.

### WHERE THE WORK LIVES

- Claude: design system, concepts canvas, Ask the Bear, test kit canvas, booklet canvas, booklet content doc
- GitHub `jessboydd/Founder-Documentary-Project-V2`: pull requests #1–#4 (design, test kit, build record, print proof)
- GitHub `jessboydd/bear-with-me`: QR forwarder and the standalone app (pull requests #1–#2)

## JESSICA'S JUDGMENT

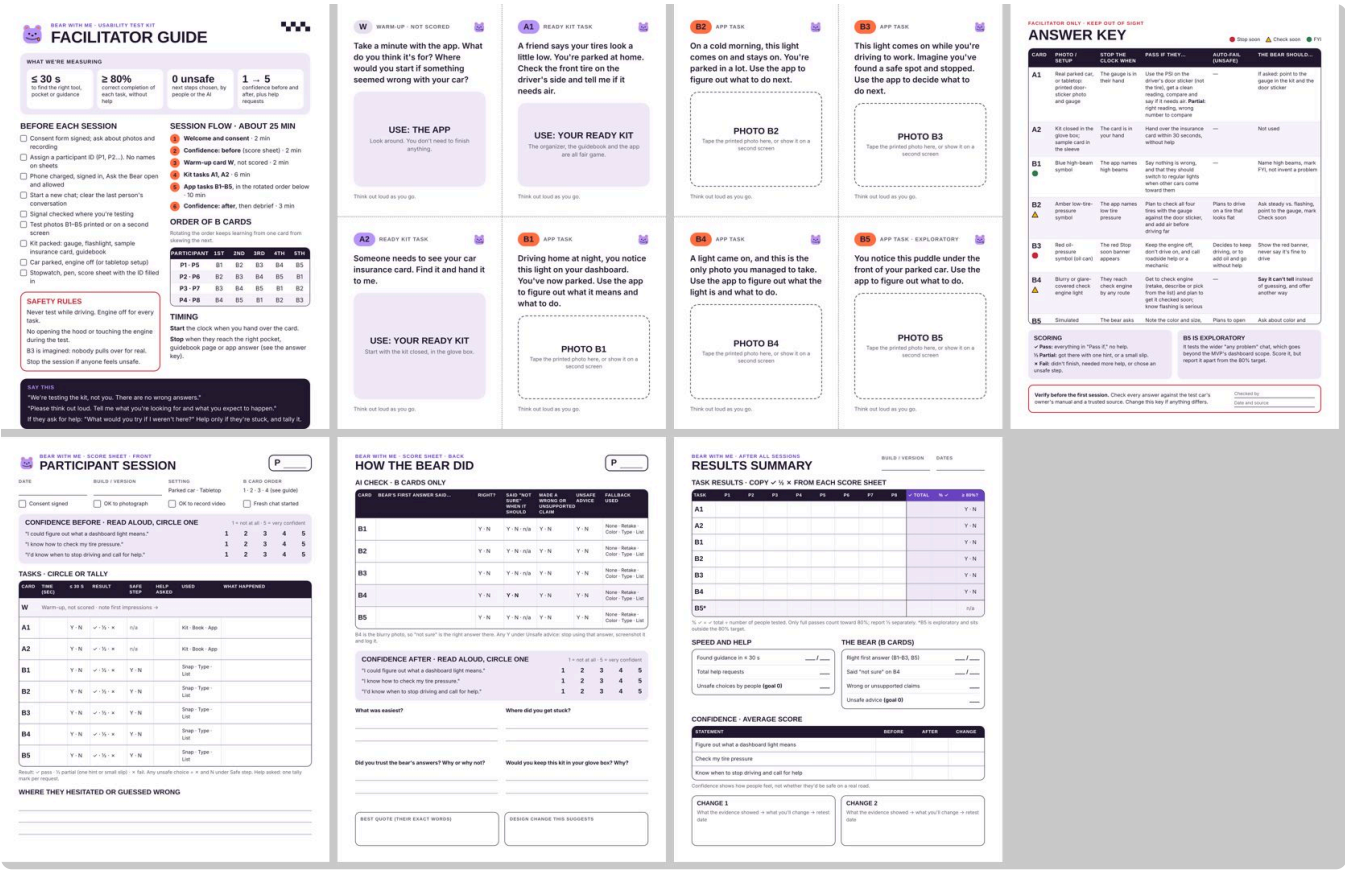
The decisions that shaped this stretch of the project, in her words where possible.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Starting from her own brief** | Wrote the creative brief (Oct 13) and the booklet brief (Oct 24) herself; Claude worked from them. Every design rule was tagged ESTABLISHED (from her brief) or NEW (a recommendation) so she could see what was hers. |
| **Widening the bear** | Asked for Ask the Bear to help "discuss any issue to help someone diagnose by the camera picture and discussion," not just six lights: people don't arrive with tidy categories. |
| **Designing for the real moment** | Asked whether the app works on a back road with weak signal, which made the printed booklet the no-signal backup. Page 3 asks where the insurance card is (kit, glove box or phone), not just which company. |
| **Testing in person, on her phone** | Chose to run usability tests on her own phone so every session matches and testers need no setup. |
| **Testing before committing** | Printed and cut two size tests (3 × 4 vs. 3.5 × 5 in) and chose 3.5 × 5 because it was easier to read, though her brief started at 3 × 4. |
| **Pushing, then stopping** | On the drawings: "can still be visually improved," then an inspiration image, then "the bear does not need that much detail," then "that is good for now." |
| **Choosing among options** | Compared three tab styles and picked A, the labeled side tab. Parked tabs that stick out from the page. |
| **Controlling scope** | Asked "are we missing any important dashboard lights?", added six, and parked the fender-bender and dead-battery pages: real needs, but outside this booklet's job. |
| **Readability over thinness** | Chose 20 pages over squeezing everything into 16 at a smaller size. |
| **Editing out** | Spotted text bleeding off page 4, cut the repeated "on page 3" reminders, dropped the light log, and asked for the can/can't lists as rows, not columns. |
| **Keeping the project separate** | "I do not and was not planning to use jessicaboyd.design for this project at all." |
| **Changing course with new information** | Had planned to give testers her Claude login; on learning that breaks Claude's terms and exposes her account, switched to building the standalone app first. |
| **Build first, accounts later** | "How about if I don't set up those accounts yet and we just move to Claude Code to continue building?" Demo mode lets the screens be tested before paying for AI. |
| **Testing it herself** | Scanned the QR code and reported it skipped the forwarding page; tried photos in the Claude mobile app and found the error; noticed the Call buttons were missing. |
| **One system** | Asked for the app to carry the booklet's 14 lights, its "My car's numbers" page, and the same bear on the home screen as in the chat. |

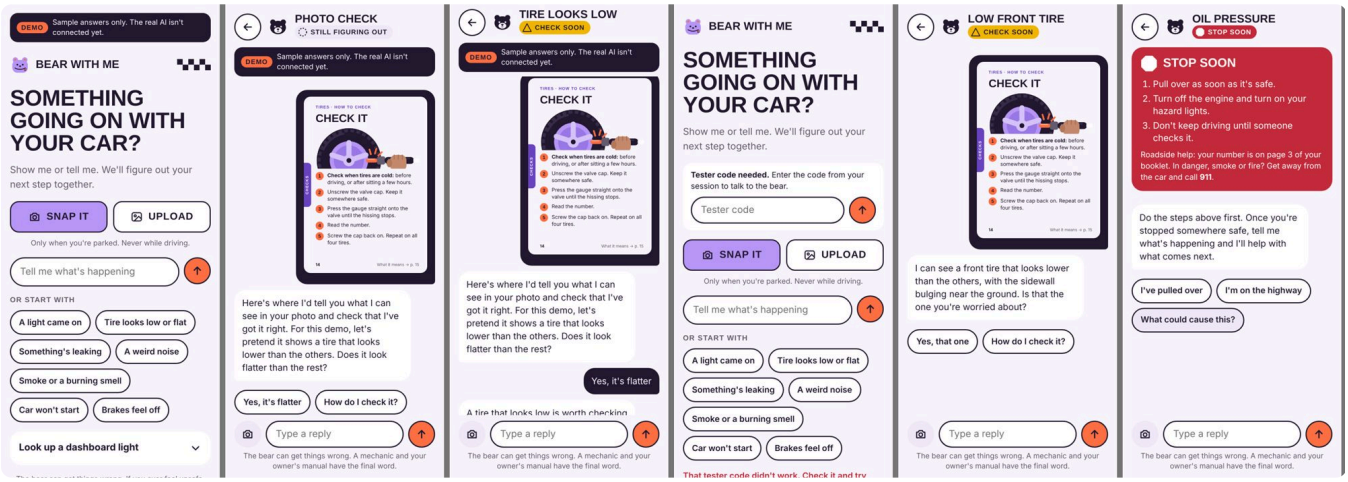
## TESTING

Checks made while building. These are design and prototype checks, not usability-test results; those come from the test kit sessions.

| When | What was tested | Found | Result |
|---|---|---|---|
| Oct 13 | Text contrast on brand colors | White text fails on lavender and orange | Buttons and labels use deep plum |
| Oct 13 | Photo button in her web browser | Didn't appear on the first try | Always shown, with a note when photos can't be sent |
| Oct 21 | Test kit design | Scenarios for stop-soon and not-sure needed real problems | Prepared test photos; blurry photo (B4) tests whether the AI admits it can't tell |
| Oct 24 | Printed size tests (pp. 5 and 11) | 3 × 4 in too small to read under stress | 3.5 × 5 in chosen |
| Oct 24 | Every page rendered at actual size | Text wrapping bugs on pp. 2, 4, 8; tight fits on Tire talk and oil set-up | Fixed and re-rendered |
| Oct 24 | Tabs on lavender pages | The lavender Checks tab vanished | Checks tab moved to darker purple #6B44C2 |
| Oct 24 | Readability (Jessica, on the full build) | Page 4 text bled into the purple; repeated "see p. 3" | References moved; reminders cut to the three that matter |
| Oct 25 | QR scan on her phone (Jessica) | Opened Ask the Bear directly; the lavender forwarding page didn't show | Scan reaches the app; QR placed in the booklet |
| Oct 25 | Demo app in a phone-size browser | Snap, upload, chat, urgency chips, stop banner, tester code, light lookup | Screens captured (below) |
| Oct 25 | Server piece with a stand-in AI | Tester code, photo size limit, rules written on the server, private numbers kept on the phone | Passed |
| Oct 25 | Photos in the Claude mobile app (Jessica) | Error when taking or uploading a photo | Cause: the Claude version never asked for photo permission; added |
| Oct 25 | Call buttons (Jessica) | Not showing | Call button added to the home screen and red stop box |




The usability test kit (Oct 21): facilitator guide, scenario cards, answer key, score sheets and results summary.

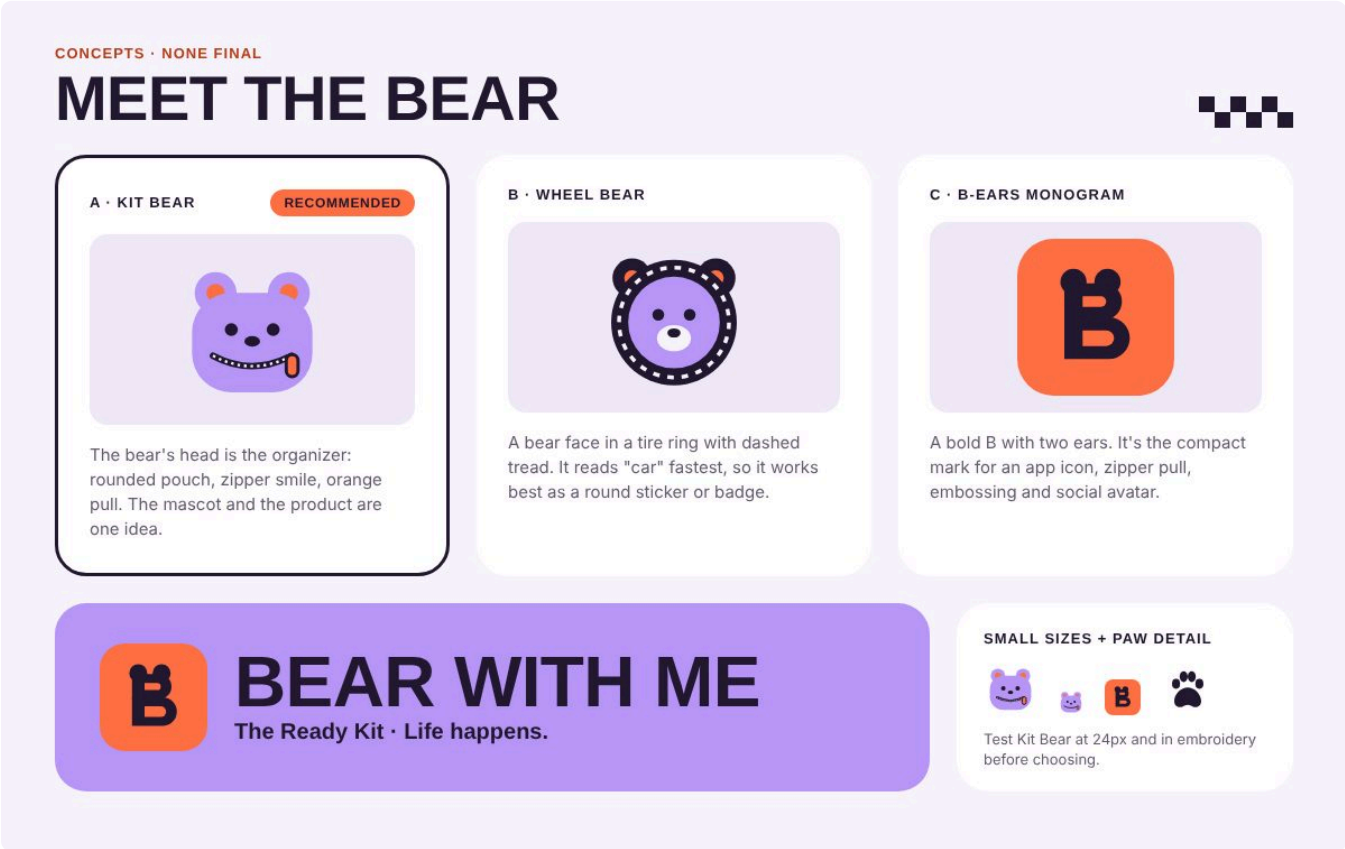



The standalone app in demo mode (Oct 25): home, photo check, tire flow, tester code, and the red stop box.

## ITERATION: WHAT CHANGED

| Part | Started as | Became |
|---|---|---|
| Ask the Bear scope | Six dashboard lights | Any car problem, with safety triage and a no-AI list |
| Booklet size | 3 × 4 in (brief) | 3.5 × 5 in after printed tests |
| Illustrations | v1 outlined drawings | v2 bold flat (from her image) → v3 richer flat; simple bold bear |
| Section tabs | Plain color strip | Labeled side tabs (option A), darker Checks tab |
| Headings | Short orange bar under each | Bar removed |
| Lights covered | 7 | 14, plus cold-weather and roadside-help notes |
| Page count | 16 | 20 |
| Page 19 | Fill-in light log | "What I can and can't do" as stacked rows |
| QR code | Placeholder | Stable link that forwards to the current app |
| App home | Claude artifact only | Its own code with demo mode, server piece, 14 lights, My car's numbers, Call buttons |

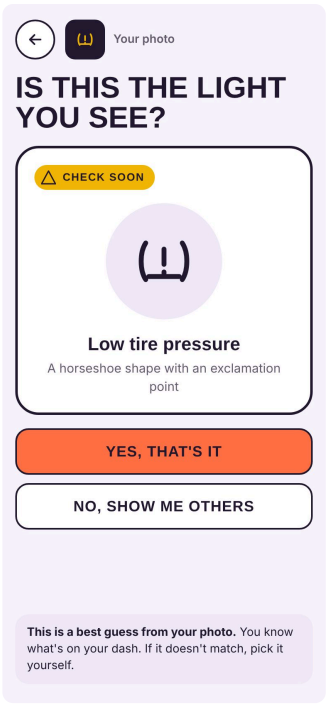
### OCTOBER 13 · CONCEPTS



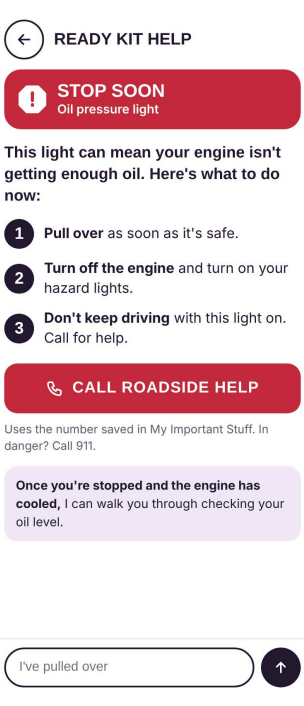

Three bear logo concepts: Kit Bear (recommended), Wheel Bear, B-Ears monogram.



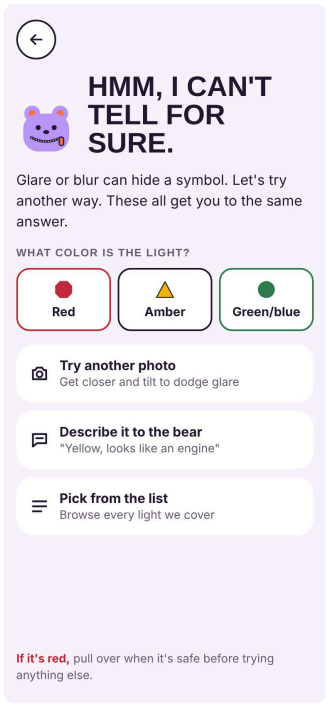

Snap




Confirm the match

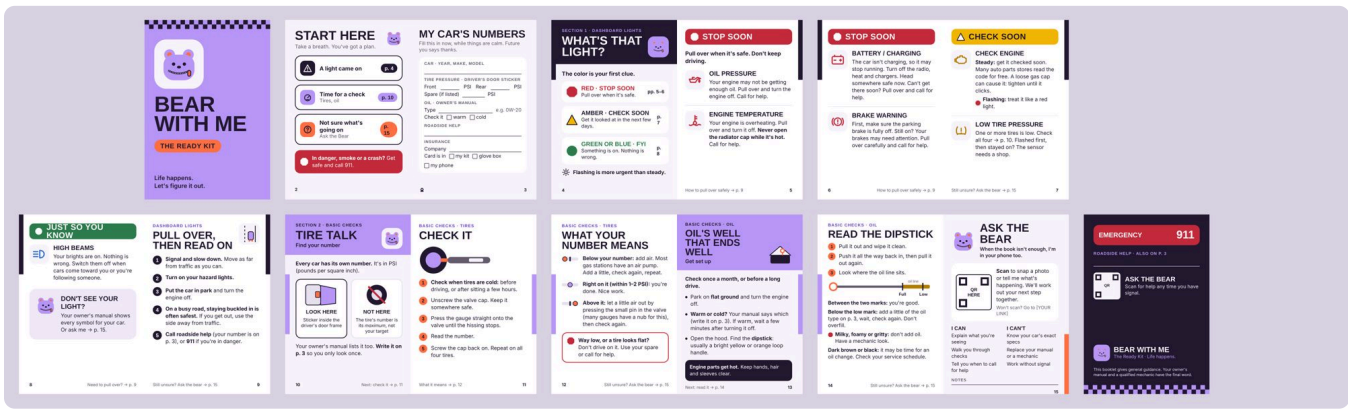



Stop soon: no bear




Not sure

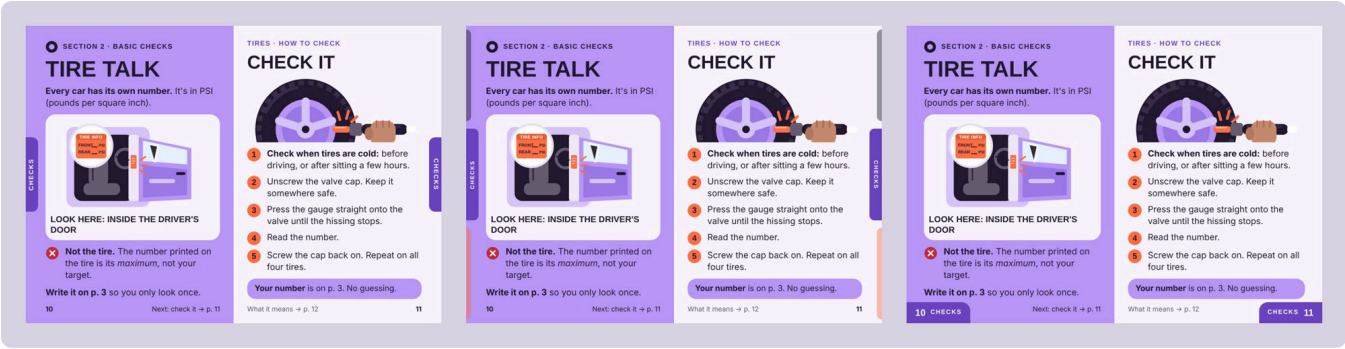
## OCTOBER 24 · THE BOOKLET TAKES SHAPE




First visual prototype: 16 pages at 3.5 × 5 in.

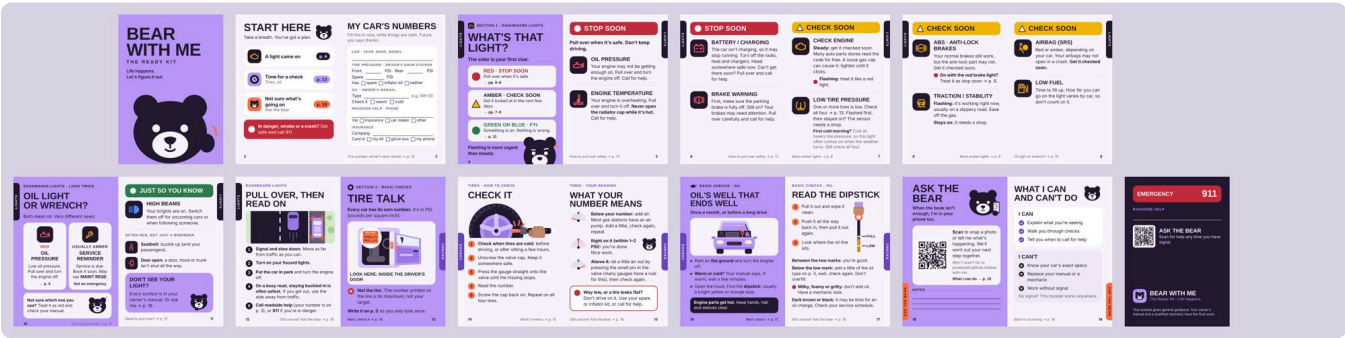



Illustration study v3, after v1 and v2: the simple bold bear in four poses and richer flat drawings.

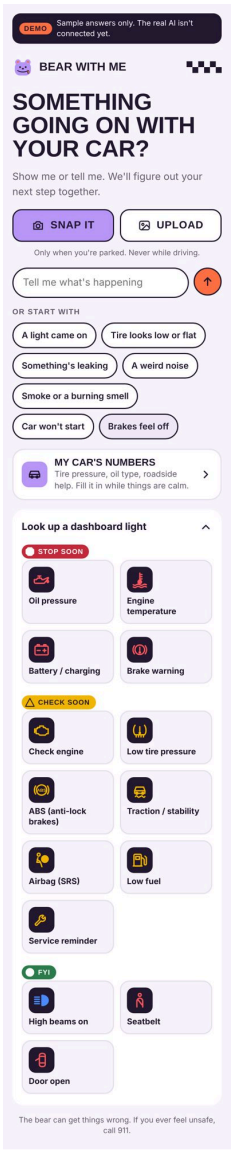



Tab styles A, B and C on the Tire talk / Check it spread. Jessica chose A.

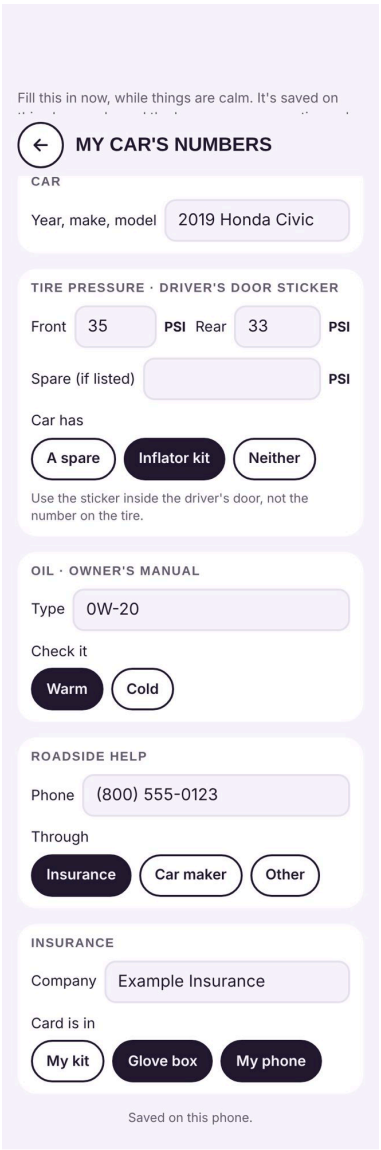
## OCTOBER 25 · 20 PAGES, QR CODE, APP




The full 20-page booklet after the readability pass, with the QR code.




The 14 booklet lights in the app




My car's numbers in the app

## OPEN AT THE END OF OCTOBER 25

- Facts for the 8 newly added lights still to verify (done Oct 30 against the RAV4 manual).
- Print and mark up the proof (done; led to the Oct 30 changes and 4 × 5 in).
- Resize the organizer pocket for the booklet.
- README conflict: "mechanical diagnosis" out of scope vs. the bear helping with any problem.
- Going live: Anthropic API and Vercel accounts, then point the QR forwarder at the live app.

# THE CONVERSATION

Dark bubbles are Jessica's words (marked "excerpt" where only part survives). Lighter bubbles describe a request whose exact wording isn't stored. Grey notes summarize what Claude did in reply.

## OCTOBER 13 · BRAND, CONCEPTS AND THE FIRST PROTOTYPE

**JESSICA · DESCRIBED, NOT WORD FOR WORD**

Shared her creative brief for Bear With Me: The Ready Kit.

**JESSICA · EXCERPT**

Use this brief as the foundation for exploring a cohesive design system...

> Design system with contrast checks, three bear logo concepts (Kit Bear recommended), and concept screens for the organizer, guidebook and phone.

**JESSICA · EXCERPT**

let's explore the snapping or sharing a photo and the chat bot helping

> Five photo + chat screens: snap, confirm the match, check soon, stop soon, not sure.

**JESSICA · EXCERPT**

can we make it interactive now

**JESSICA · EXCERPT**

discuss any issue to help someone diagnose by the camera picture and discussion

> Working Ask the Bear prototype; widened from six lights to any car problem, keeping the safety triage. The photo button didn't show in her browser at first and was fixed.

**JESSICA · DESCRIBED, NOT WORD FOR WORD**

Asked whether the app would work with weak or no signal, and talked through a native app vs. an installable web app.

> The printed booklet became the no-signal backup.

## OCTOBER 21 · GITHUB AND THE TEST KIT

**JESSICA · DESCRIBED, NOT WORD FOR WORD**

Asked to save the design system, mockups and prototype to the project repo, then to design a usability test kit.

> Pull request #1 (design work) and #2 (test kit: facilitator guide, 8 scenario cards, answer key, score sheets, results summary). Testers will use her phone in person.

## OCTOBER 24 · THE POCKET BOOKLET

JESSICA · HER BOOKLET BRIEF, OPENING

Before I continue developing the app in Claude Code and testing the product, I want to focus on designing and building the Bear With Me: The Ready Kit physical booklet.

This booklet will go inside the Ready Kit organizer alongside a tire pressure gauge, small flashlight, and a designated space for vehicle registration and important documents.

The Vision

I'm imagining a small booklet, approximately 3 × 4 inches, that feels fun, inviting, approachable, and genuinely helpful.

...

> Four-step plan: format and structure → content and layout → visual prototype → print-ready file. Proposed 16 pages, stapled, colored section tabs, QR on p. 15 and the back cover.

JESSICA · DESCRIBED, NOT WORD FOR WORD

Approved the format decisions (3 × 4 in to test against 3.5 × 5, stapled 16 pages, seven lights with the brake light added, a fill-in numbers page, colored tabs, no bear on stop pages).

> Page-by-page content with verify flags, plus two printable size-test sheets.

JESSICA · DESCRIBED, NOT WORD FOR WORD

Printed and compared the size tests: chose 3.5 × 5 in. Approved the content with one change: page 3 asks for the insurance company and where the card is.

> All 16 pages designed as reading spreads.

JESSICA · ON THE DRAWINGS, EXCERPT

can still be visually improved

JESSICA · DESCRIBED, NOT WORD FOR WORD

Attached an inspiration image for a bolder flat style.

JESSICA · EXCERPT

the bear does not need that much detail

JESSICA · EXCERPT

that is good for now

> v2 then v3 illustrations; the bear simplified to a bold head, a paw and one prop in four poses. All 16 pages rebuilt in v3.

JESSICA

Let's explore adding tabs and removing the short orange bar

> Three tab styles on the Tire talk / Check it spread (image in Iteration).

JESSICA

Let's go with A

JESSICA

what if the tabs stuck out from the page?

> Explained: stick-on or die-cut tabs, with cost and assembly trade-offs.

JESSICA

Let's pause that idea for now. Are we missing any important details or dashboard lights?

> Suggested ABS, traction/stability, airbag, service reminder, low fuel, seatbelt and door-open lights, plus cold-weather and roadside-help notes.

JESSICA · DESCRIBED, NOT WORD FOR WORD

Long reply: parked the minor-crash and dead-battery content for later, and asked to add the listed lights and details.

> They didn't fit 16 pages at a readable size. Question card: 20 pages or squeeze?

JESSICA · QUESTION-CARD ANSWER

Go to 20 pages

JESSICA

okay

JESSICA

Some of the layout needs to be fixed for readability. For example the pp.7-9 bleeding over the white intot he purple on page 4. Not sure we need all the "on page 3" reminders. The I can and can't do on page 18 could be laid out better to make it easier to read, instead of 2 colums maybe 2 rows? I don't think the light log is needed, maybe the can and can't info could go there?

> Readability pass done.

## OCTOBER 25 · QR CODE, PRINT PROOF, AND THE APP LEAVES CLAUDE

JESSICA

Okay, not show me the full build with these updates

> All 20 pages shown as spreads.

JESSICA

Before creating a print-ready version, so I can print it out, read it over, and make edits to it. How about we create the QR code that will link to the App. Or should we build the app in Claude Code first, or can we move what we have built already into Claude Code for the App?

> Recommended a QR that points to a stable address that forwards to the app, so printed booklets never break. Asked where it should live.

JESSICA

No, I do not and was not planning to use https://jessicaboyd.design/ for this project at all.

JESSICA

Yes, let's go with option 1. ... Yes, this works! ... I have not shared it with anyone yet, I was planning to give people my claude login for user testing.

> Set up jessboydd.github.io/bear-with-me. Explained that sharing a Claude login breaks Claude's terms and exposes her account; recommended the standalone app before testing.

**JESSICA**

Oh I see! Sorry about that and thank you for the info!

**JESSICA · DESCRIBED, NOT WORD FOR WORD**

Created the public bear-with-me repo and turned on GitHub Pages when asked ("Done." / "Saved").

**JESSICA**

I tested the QR code and this part does not happen: A lavender "Bear With Me" page appears for a moment. It opens me straight to It forwards to the Ask the Bear app in Claude.

> Claude checked the forwarding page; the scan reached Ask the Bear, which is the job the link does. QR placed on p. 18 and the back cover; first print proof made.

**JESSICA**

Okay

**JESSICA**

Great, this is printed and I will work on what needs to be changed or updated for it after reviewing it. How about we go back to the app? Should we move the app into Claude Code now? ...

> Explained what moving out of Claude needs: an AI account and a host that can keep a key secret.

**JESSICA**

How about if I don't set up those accounts yet and we just move to claude code to cotinue building?

> Standalone app built with demo mode and the server piece (pull request #1 in bear-with-me).

**JESSICA**

Let's update the app with the 14 lights we have in the booklet.

**JESSICA**

Also let's update the app with a car's numbers log, like how we have in the booklet ...

> 14 lights grouped by color; My car's numbers saved on the phone only.

**JESSICA**

For the app, when I try to take and upload a picture, I get the error message: ... I am currently working in the Claude mobile app to test it.

**JESSICA**

Explain to me again, why can't I do the photo capture or upload test through my app on Claude?

**JESSICA**

I see and can still test the app here on Claude without the photo features. Also, should we move it over to Claude Code now?

**JESSICA**

I merged that pull request. Could we update the app that we built here to have the same features as the new app in the demo?

> Claude version brought up to date from the new app's code.

**JESSICA**

I want the chat bear to be the bear on the home screen and I am not seeing Call buttons ...

> Booklet bear on the home screen, Call button added, photo permission added (the cause of the photo error), reliable saving.

**JESSICA**

what are some examples of my judgement that I have made in our discussions with the booklet and app

**JESSICA · TO SAVING THEM IN THE BUILD RECORD**

Yes

> Saved as the "Founder decisions" section of the build record.